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Turbine engine having a rotatable disk and a blade

Abstract

A turbine engine has a rotatable disk, a seal cartridge, and a blade. The rotatable disk has a peripheral surface, with at least one slot located in the peripheral surface. The seal cartridge defines a blade seat. The blade has a root, a leading edge and a trailing edge, the root being received within the blade seat.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The disclosure generally relates to a turbine engine, and specifically to a turbine engine having rotatable disk and a blade receivable by the rotatable disk.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(2) Turbine engines, and particularly gas or combustion turbine engines, are rotary engines that extract energy from a flow of gases passing through a fan section, a compression section, a combustion section and a turbine section. The fan section includes a plurality of fan blades. The compression section includes a series of compressor stages, which include pairs of rotating blades and stationary vanes. The turbine section includes a series of turbine stages, which include pairs of rotating blades and stationary vanes. The blades are mounted to rotating disks, while the vanes are mounted to stationary portions of the turbine engine.

(3) During operation, air is brought into the compressor section through the fan section. The air is then pressurized in the compressor and mixed with fuel in the combustor for generating hot combustion gases. The hot combustion gases flow downstream through the turbine stages. In the turbine stages, the air is expanded and ultimately exhausted out an exhaust section. The expansion of the air in the turbine section is used to drive the rotation sections of the fan section and the compressor section. The drawing in of air, the pressurization of the air, and the expansion of the air is done, in part, through rotation of various rotating blades mounted to respective disks throughout the fan section, the compressor section, and the turbine section. The rotation of the blades imparts mechanical stresses along various portions of the blade; specifically, where the blade is mounted to the rotatable disk.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) A full and enabling disclosure of the present disclosure, including the best mode thereof, directed to one of ordinary skill in the art, is set forth in the specification, which makes reference to the appended figures, in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a schematic cross-sectional view of a turbine engine in accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (3) FIG. 2 is a schematic exploded perspective view of a blade assembly including a rotatable disk, a blade and a seal cartridge suitable for use within the turbine engine of FIG. 1, the seal cartridge including a plate partially defining a blade seat for the blade.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a schematic top perspective view of the seal cartridge of FIG. 2, further illustrating a pocket formed along the plate and adapted to receive the blade.
- (5) FIG. 4 is a schematic bottom perspective view of the seal cartridge of FIG. 2, further illustrating a flow passage formed along a respective portion of the seal cartridge.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a schematic side cross-sectional assembled view of the blade assembly of FIG. 2, further illustrating a first flow passage and a second flow passage formed between the seal cartridge and the rotatable disk, and the seal cartridge and the blade, respectively.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a rear schematic view of the blade assembly of FIG. 2 with the blade removed, further illustrating two circumferentially adjacent seal cartridges with a spline seal extending therebetween.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS OF THE INVENTION

- (8) Aspects of the disclosure herein are directed to a turbine engine including a rotatable disk, a blade, and a seal cartridge. The rotatable disk is rotatable about a rotational axis and includes a slot. The blade and the seal cartridge are receivable within the slot. The seal cartridge includes a plate and at least one arm that together form a blade seat. The seal cartridge lays radially between the blade and a lower portion of the slot.
- (9) The seal cartridge is coupled to the blade via the at least one arm. The seal cartridge thermally insulates the bottom of the slot from the bottom, or root, of the blade. For purposes of illustration, the present disclosure will be described with respect to a turbine engine. It will be understood, however, that aspects of the disclosure described herein are not so limited and can have general applicability within other engines or within other portions of the turbine engine. For example, the disclosure can have applicability for a rotatable disk, seal cartridge, and blade in other engines or vehicles, and can be used to provide benefits in industrial, commercial, and residential applications.
- (10) As used herein, the term “upstream” refers to a direction that is opposite the fluid flow direction, and the term “downstream” refers to a direction that is in the same direction as the fluid flow. The term “fore” or “forward” means in front of something and “aft” or “rearward” means behind something.
- (11) Additionally, as used herein, the terms “radial” or “radially” refer to a direction away from a common center. For example, in the overall context of a turbine engine, radial refers to a direction along a ray extending between a center longitudinal axis of the engine and an outer engine circumference.
- (12) Furthermore, as used herein, the term “set” or a “set” of elements can be any number of elements, including only one.
- (13) Further yet, as used herein, the term “fluid” or iterations thereof can refer to any suitable fluid within the gas turbine engine at least a portion of the gas turbine engine is exposed to such as, but not limited to, combustion gases, ambient air, pressurized airflow, working airflow, or any combination thereof. It is yet further contemplated that the gas turbine engine can be other suitable turbine engine such as, but not limited to, a steam turbine engine or a supercritical carbon dioxide

turbine engine. As a non-limiting example, the term “fluid” can refer to steam in a steam turbine engine, or to carbon dioxide in a supercritical carbon dioxide turbine engine.

(14) All directional references (e.g., radial, axial, proximal, distal, upper, lower, upward, downward, left, right, lateral, front, back, top, bottom, above, below, vertical, horizontal, clockwise, counterclockwise, upstream, downstream, forward, aft, etc.) are only used for identification purposes to aid the reader's understanding of the present disclosure, and do not create limitations, particularly as to the position, orientation, or use of aspects of the disclosure described herein.

(15) Connection references (e.g., attached, coupled, secured, fastened, connected, and joined) are to be construed broadly and can include intermediate members between a collection of elements and relative movement between elements unless otherwise indicated. As such, connection references do not necessarily infer that two elements are directly connected and in fixed relation to one another. The exemplary drawings are for purposes of illustration only and the dimensions, positions, order and relative sizes reflected in the drawings attached hereto can vary.

(16) The term “composite,” as used herein is, is indicative of a component having two or more materials. A composite can be a combination of at least two metallic or non-metallic elements or materials; or a combination of metallic and non-metallic elements or materials. Examples of a composite material can be, but are not limited to, a polymer matrix composite (PMC), a ceramic matrix composite (CMC), a metal matrix composite (MMC), carbon fibers, a polymeric resin, a thermoplastic resin, bismaleimide (BMI) materials, polyimide materials, an epoxy resin, glass fibers, and silicon matrix materials.

(17) As used herein, a “composite” component refers to a structure or a component including any suitable composite material. Composite components, such as a composite airfoil, can include several layers or plies of composite material. The layers or plies can vary in stiffness, material, and dimension to achieve the desired composite component or composite portion of a component having a predetermined weight, size, stiffness, and strength.

(18) One or more layers of adhesive can be used in forming or coupling composite components. Adhesives can include resin and phenolics, wherein the adhesive can require curing at elevated temperatures or other hardening techniques.

(19) As used herein, PMC refers to a class of materials. By way of example, the PMC material is defined in part by a prepreg, which is a reinforcement material pre-impregnated with a polymer matrix material, such as thermoplastic resin. Non-limiting examples of processes for producing thermoplastic prepregs include hot melt pre-pregging in which the fiber reinforcement material is drawn through a molten bath of resin and powder pre-pregging in which a resin is deposited onto the fiber reinforcement material, by way of non-limiting example electrostatically, and then adhered to the fiber, by way of non-limiting example, in an oven or with the assistance of heated rollers. The prepregs can be in the form of unidirectional tapes or woven fabrics, which are then stacked on top of one another to create the number of stacked plies desired for the part.

(20) Multiple layers of prepreg are stacked to the proper thickness and orientation for the composite component and then the resin is cured and solidified to render a fiber reinforced composite part. Resins for matrix materials of PMCs can be generally classified as thermosets or thermoplastics. Thermoplastic resins are generally categorized as polymers that can be repeatedly softened and flowed when heated and hardened when sufficiently cooled due to physical rather than chemical changes. Notable example classes of thermoplastic resins include nylons, thermoplastic polyesters, polyaryletherketones, and polycarbonate resins. Specific example of high performance thermoplastic resins that have been contemplated for use in aerospace applications include, polyetheretherketone (PEEK), polyetherketoneketone (PEKK), polyetherimide (PEI), polyaryletherketone (PAEK), and polyphenylene sulfide (PPS). In contrast, once fully cured into a hard rigid solid, thermoset resins do not undergo significant softening when heated, but instead thermally decompose when sufficiently heated. Notable examples of thermoset resins include

epoxy, bismaleimide (BMI), and polyimide resins.

(21) Instead of using a prepreg, in another non-limiting example, with the use of thermoplastic polymers, it is possible to utilize a woven fabric. Woven fabric can include, but is not limited to, dry carbon fibers woven together with thermoplastic polymer fibers or filaments. Non-prepreg braided architectures can be made in a similar fashion. With this approach, it is possible to tailor the fiber volume of the part by dictating the relative concentrations of the thermoplastic fibers and reinforcement fibers that have been woven or braided together. Additionally, different types of reinforcement fibers can be braided or woven together in various concentrations to tailor the properties of the part. For example, glass fibers, carbon fibers, and thermoplastic fibers could all be woven together in various concentrations to tailor the properties of the part. The carbon fibers provide the strength of the system, the glass fibers can be incorporated to enhance the impact properties, which is a design characteristic for parts located near the inlet of the engine, and the thermoplastic fibers provide the binding for the reinforcement fibers.

(22) In yet another non-limiting example, resin transfer molding (RTM) can be used to form at least a portion of a composite component. Generally, RTM includes the application of dry fibers or matrix material to a mold or cavity. The dry fibers or matrix material can include prepreg, braided material, woven material, or any combination thereof.

(23) Resin can be pumped into or otherwise provided to the mold or cavity to impregnate the dry fibers or matrix material. The combination of the impregnated fibers or matrix material and the resin are then cured and removed from the mold. When removed from the mold, the composite component can require post-curing processing.

(24) It is contemplated that RTM can be a vacuum assisted process. That is, the air from the cavity or mold can be removed and replaced by the resin prior to heating or curing. It is further contemplated that the placement of the dry fibers or matrix material can be manual or automated.

(25) The dry fibers or matrix material can be contoured to shape the composite component or direct the resin. Optionally, additional layers or reinforcing layers of a material differing from the dry fiber or matrix material can also be included or added prior to heating or curing.

(26) As used herein, CMC refers to a class of materials with reinforcing fibers in a ceramic matrix. Generally, the reinforcing fibers provide structural integrity to the ceramic matrix. Some examples of reinforcing fibers can include, but are not limited to, non-oxide silicon-based materials (e.g., silicon carbide, silicon nitride, or mixtures thereof), non-oxide carbon-based materials (e.g., carbon), oxide ceramics (e.g., silicon oxycarbides, silicon oxynitrides, aluminum oxide (Al_2O_3), silicon dioxide (SiO_2), aluminosilicates such as mullite, or mixtures thereof), or mixtures thereof.

(27) Some examples of ceramic matrix materials can include, but are not limited to, non-oxide silicon-based materials (e.g., silicon carbide, silicon nitride, or mixtures thereof), oxide ceramics (e.g., silicon oxycarbides, silicon oxynitrides, aluminum oxide (Al_2O_3), silicon dioxide (SiO_2), aluminosilicates, or mixtures thereof), or mixtures thereof. Optionally, ceramic particles (e.g., oxides of Si, Al, Zr, Y, and combinations thereof) and inorganic fillers (e.g., pyrophyllite, wollastonite, mica, talc, kyanite, and montmorillonite) can also be included within the ceramic matrix.

(28) Generally, particular CMCs can be referred to as their combination of type of fiber/type of matrix. For example, C/SiC for carbon-fiber-reinforced silicon carbide; SiC/SiC for silicon carbide-fiber-reinforced silicon carbide, SiC/SiN for silicon carbide fiber-reinforced silicon nitride; SiC/SiC—SiN for silicon carbide fiber-reinforced silicon carbide/silicon nitride matrix mixture, etc. In other examples, the CMCs can be comprised of a matrix and reinforcing fibers comprising oxide-based materials such as aluminum oxide (Al_2O_3), silicon dioxide (SiO_2), aluminosilicates, and mixtures thereof. Aluminosilicates can include crystalline materials such as mullite ($3\text{Al}_2\text{O}_3 \cdot 2\text{SiO}_2$), as well as glassy aluminosilicates.

(29) In certain non-limiting examples, the reinforcing fibers may be bundled and/or coated prior to

inclusion within the matrix. For example, bundles of the fibers may be formed as a reinforced tape, such as a unidirectional reinforced tape. A plurality of the tapes may be laid up together to form a preform component. The bundles of fibers may be impregnated with a slurry composition prior to forming the preform or after formation of the preform. The preform may then undergo thermal processing, and subsequent chemical processing to arrive at a component formed of a CMC material having a desired chemical composition. For example, the preform may undergo a cure or burn-out to yield a high char residue in the preform, and subsequent melt-infiltration with silicon, or a cure or pyrolysis to yield a silicon carbide matrix in the preform, and subsequent chemical vapor infiltration with silicon carbide. Additional steps may be taken to improve densification of the preform, either before or after chemical vapor infiltration, by injecting it with a liquid resin or polymer followed by a thermal processing step to fill the voids with silicon carbide. CMC material as used herein may be formed using any known or hereinafter developed methods including but not limited to melt infiltration, chemical vapor infiltration, polymer impregnation pyrolysis (PIP), or any combination thereof.

(30) Such materials, along with certain monolithic ceramics (i.e., ceramic materials without a reinforcing material), are particularly suitable for higher temperature applications. Additionally, these ceramic materials are lightweight compared to superalloys, yet can still provide strength and durability to the component made therefrom. Therefore, such materials are currently being considered for many gas turbine components used in higher temperature sections of gas turbine engines, such as airfoils (e.g., turbines, and vanes), combustors, shrouds and other like components, that would benefit from the lighter-weight and higher temperature capability these materials can offer.

(31) The term “metallic” as used herein is indicative of a material that includes metal such as, but not limited to, titanium, iron, aluminum, stainless steel, and nickel alloys. A metallic material or alloy can be a combination of at least two or more elements or materials, where at least one is a metal.

(32) FIG. 1 is a schematic cross-sectional diagram of a turbine engine **10** for an aircraft. The turbine engine **10** has a generally longitudinally extending axis or centerline **12** extending forward **14** to aft **16**. The turbine engine **10** includes, in a downstream serial flow relationship: a fan section **18** including a fan **20**; a compressor section **22** including a booster or low pressure (LP) compressor **24** and a high pressure (HP) compressor **26**; a combustion section **28** including a combustor **30**; a turbine section **32** including a HP turbine **34** and a LP turbine **36**; and an exhaust section **38**. The turbine engine **10** as described herein is meant as a non-limiting example. Other architectures are possible, such as, but not limited to, an unducted turbine engine, a steam turbine engine, a supercritical carbon dioxide turbine engine, or any other suitable turbine engine.

(33) The fan section **18** includes a fan casing **40** surrounding the fan **20**. The fan **20** includes a plurality of fan blades **42** disposed radially about the engine centerline **12**. The HP compressor **26**, the combustor **30**, and the HP turbine **34** form an engine core **44** of the turbine engine **10**. The engine core **44** generates combustion gases. The engine core **44** is surrounded by a core casing **46**, which can be coupled with the fan casing **40**.

(34) An HP shaft **48** is disposed coaxially about the engine centerline **12** of the turbine engine **10**. The HP shaft **48** drivingly connects the HP turbine **34** to the HP compressor **26**. An LP shaft **50** is disposed coaxially about the engine centerline **12** of the turbine engine **10** and within the larger diameter annular HP shaft **48**. The LP shaft **50** drivingly connects the LP turbine **36** to the LP compressor **24** and fan **20**. The shafts **48**, **50** are rotatable about the engine centerline **12** and couple to a plurality of rotatable elements, which can collectively define a rotor **51**.

(35) The LP compressor **24** and the HP compressor **26** respectively include a plurality of compressor stages **52**, **54**. In the compressor stages **52**, **54**, a set of compressor blades **56**, **58** rotate relative to a corresponding set of static compressor vanes **60**, **62** to compress or pressurize the stream of fluid passing through the stage. In a single compressor stage **52**, **54**, multiple compressor

blades **56, 58** can be provided in a ring and can extend radially outward relative to the engine centerline **12**. The compressor blades **56, 58** extend from a blade platform to a blade tip. The corresponding static compressor vanes **60, 62** are positioned upstream of and adjacent to the rotating compressor blades **56, 58**. It is noted that the number of blades, vanes, and compressor stages shown in FIG. **1** were selected for illustrative purposes only, and that other numbers are possible.

(36) The compressor blades **56, 58** for a stage **52, 54** of the compressor **24, 26** can be mounted to (or integral to) a disk **61**. The disk **61** is mounted to a corresponding one of the HP and LP shafts **48, 50**. The static compressor vanes **60, 62** for a stage **52, 54** of the compressor **24, 26** can be mounted to the core casing **46** in a circumferential arrangement.

(37) The HP turbine **34** and the LP turbine **36** respectively include a plurality of turbine stages **64, 66**. In the turbine stages **64, 66**, a set of turbine blades **68, 70** are rotated relative to a corresponding set of static turbine vanes **72, 74** to extract energy from the stream of fluid passing through the stage. The set of static turbine vanes **72, 74** are also referred to as a nozzle.

(38) In a single turbine stage **64, 66**, multiple turbine blades **68, 70** can be provided in a ring and can extend radially outward relative to the engine centerline **12**. The corresponding static turbine vanes **72, 74** are positioned upstream of and adjacent to the rotating turbine blades **68, 70**. It is noted that the number of blades, vanes, and turbine stages shown in FIG. **1** were selected for illustrative purposes only, and that other numbers are possible.

(39) The turbine blades **68, 70** for a stage of the turbine can be mounted to a disk **71**. The disk **71** is mounted to the corresponding one of the HP and LP shafts **48, 50**. The turbine vanes **72, 74** for a stage of the compressor can be mounted to the core casing **46** in a circumferential arrangement.

(40) Complementary to the rotor portion, the stationary portions of the turbine engine **10** are also referred to individually or collectively as a stator **63**. As such, the stator **63** can refer to the combination of non-rotating elements throughout the turbine engine **10**. The stationary portions can include the static vanes **60, 62, 72, 74** of the compressor and turbine sections **22, 32**.

(41) It will be appreciated that the turbine engine **10** can be split into at least two separate portions: a rotor portion and a stator portion. The rotor portion can be defined as any portion of the turbine engine **10** that rotates about a respective rotational axis. The stator portion can be defined by a combination of non-rotating elements provided within the turbine engine **10**. As a non-limiting example, the rotor portion can include one or more of the plurality of fan blades **42**, the compressor blades **56, 58**, or the turbine blades **68, 70**. As a non-limiting example, the stator portion can include one or more of the plurality of fan vanes **82**, the static compressor vanes **60, 62**, or the static turbine vanes **72, 74**.

(42) In operation, the airflow exiting the fan section **18** is split such that a portion of the airflow is channeled into the LP compressor **24**, which then supplies a pressurized airflow **76** to the HP compressor **26**, which further pressurizes the air. The pressurized airflow **76** from the HP compressor **26** is mixed with fuel in the combustor **30** and ignited, thereby generating combustion gases. Some work is extracted from these gases by the HP turbine **34**, which drives the HP compressor **26**. The combustion gases are discharged into the LP turbine **36**, which extracts additional work to drive the LP compressor **24**, and the exhaust gas is ultimately discharged from the turbine engine **10** via the exhaust section **38**. The driving of the LP turbine **36** drives the LP spool **50** to rotate the fan **20** and the LP compressor **24**.

(43) A portion of the pressurized airflow **76** can be drawn from the compressor section **22** as bleed air **77**. The bleed air **77** can be drawn from the pressurized airflow **76** and provided to engine components for cooling. The temperature of pressurized airflow **76** entering the combustor **30** is significantly increased above the bleed air temperature. The bleed air **77** may be used to reduce the temperature of the core components downstream of the combustor **30**. The bleed air **77** can also be utilized by other systems.

(44) Some of the air supplied by the fan **20** can bypass the engine core **44** and be used for cooling

of portions, especially hot portions, of the turbine engine **10**, and/or used to cool or power other aspects of the aircraft. In the context of a turbine engine, the hot portions of the engine are normally downstream of the combustor **30**, especially the turbine section **32**, with the HP turbine **34** being the hottest portion as it is directly downstream of the combustion section **28**. Other sources of cooling fluid can be, but are not limited to, fluid discharged from the LP compressor **24** or the HP compressor **26**.

(45) A remaining portion of the airflow exiting the fan section **18** is referred to as a bypass airflow **78**. The bypass airflow **78** bypasses the LP compressor **24** and engine core **44** and exits the turbine engine **10** at a fan exhaust side **84** through a stationary vane row. More particularly, the stationary vane row is an outlet guide vane assembly **80**. The outlet guide vane assembly **80** comprises a plurality of airfoil guide vanes **82**. More specifically, a circumferential row of radially extending airfoil guide vanes **82** are utilized adjacent the fan section **18** to exert at least some directional control of the airflow **78**.

(46) FIG. 2 is a schematic perspective view of a blade assembly **100** including a rotatable disk **102**, a blade **104**, and a seal cartridge **136** suitable for use within the turbine engine **10** of FIG. 1. The rotatable disk **102** is suitable for use as the rotatable disk **61**, **71** (FIG. 1) or any other disk such as, but not limited to, a disk within the fan section **18** (FIG. 1) of the turbine engine **10** (FIG. 1). The rotatable disk **102** is rotatable about a rotational axis **106** that can coincide with or be offset from the engine centerline (e.g., the engine centerline **12** of FIG. 1).

(47) The rotatable disk **102** includes a forward surface **130** and an aft surface **132** with a peripheral surface **134** interconnecting the forward surface **130** and the aft surface **132**. The rotatable disk **102** includes a plurality of slots **108** formed at the periphery of the rotatable disk **102**. The plurality of slots **108** extend between a forward opening **101** formed along the forward surface **130**, an aft opening **103** formed along the aft surface **132**, and a peripheral opening **105** formed along the peripheral surface **134**. Each slot of the plurality of slots **108** extends radially inward from the peripheral surface **134** towards the rotational axis **106** and terminates at a respective slot inner surface **180**. Each slot of the plurality of slots **108** extends a total circumferential distance that is less than a total axial distance that the slot extends along the peripheral surface **134**.

(48) While illustrated as a plurality of axially-extending slots **108**, it will be appreciated that at least a portion of the slots can extend non-axially. As a non-limiting example, the plurality of slots **108** can be circumferentially skewed such that at least one slot of the plurality of slots **108** includes a first portion that is circumferentially displaced from another portion spaced from the first portion. As a non-limiting example, at least one slot of the plurality of slots **108** can include an opening along the forward surface **130** that is circumferentially spaced from an opening on the aft surface **132**.

(49) The rotatable disk **102** further comprises an axial retainer assembly **178** provided along the forward surface **130**. The axial retainer assembly can include an axial retainer **190** extending circumferentially about the rotational axis **106**. The axial retainer **190** overlays the forward opening **101**. While only a portion of the axial retainer assembly **178** is illustrated, it will be appreciated that the axial retainer assembly **178** can extend continuously about an entirety of the rotational axis **106**. The axial retainer **190** can be continuous or segmented about the rotational axis **106**. The axial retainer assembly **178** can be provided along the forward surface **130**, the aft surface **132** or a combination thereof.

(50) The blade **104** includes an airfoil portion **110** and a shank **112** extending from the airfoil portion **110**. The shank **112** meets the airfoil portion **110** at a transition **126**. The shank **112** can define a portion of the blade **104** that flares circumferentially outward from the airfoil portion **110**. The shank **112** defines a portion of the blade **104** receivable within a respective slot of the plurality of slots **108**.

(51) The airfoil portion **110** extends between a leading edge **114** and a trailing edge **116** to define a chord-wise direction. The blade **104** extends between a root **118** and a tip **120** to define a span-wise

direction. The shank **112** terminates radially at the root **118**. The airfoil portion **110** includes a pressure side **122** and a suction side **124**.

(52) The seal cartridge **136** includes a plate **138** and at least one arm extending radially from the plate **138**. The plate **138** is an axially-extending body of the seal cartridge **136**. As a non-limiting example, the seal cartridge **136** can include a first arm **140** and a second arm **142**, with the second arm **142** axially spaced from the first arm **140**. While two arms, the first arm **140** and the second arm **142**, are illustrated, it will be appreciated that the seal cartridge **136** can include one or more arms that extend radially from the plate **138**.

(53) The plate **138**, the first arm **140**, and the second arm **142** can be formed as a unitary body. As used herein, the term “unitary body” refers to a single component or assembly of components that are physically touching to collectively define a singular body. As a non-limiting example, the plate **138**, the first arm **140** and the second arm **142** can form a unitary body by being unitarily formed (e.g., formed as a single, continuous piece), coupled to each other (e.g., the first arm **140** or the second arm **142** can be coupled to the plate **138**), or a combination thereof. In terms of the unitary body being defined by bodies coupled to one another, the coupling can be done through, but is not limited to, welding, adhesion, bonding, clamping, fastening, or a combination thereof. As a non-limiting example, the first arm **140**, the second arm **142** and the plate **138** can be formed as cast, molded, printed (e.g., 3-D printing), or a combination thereof into the unitary body.

(54) The seal cartridge **136** defines a blade seat **144** adapted to house a respective portion of the blade **104**. The plate **138** and the at least one arm collectively define the blade seat **144**. The blade seat **144** can be sized to seat any suitable portion of the blade **104**. As a non-limiting example, the blade seat **144** can be sized to seat the shank **112**, specifically the root **118** of the shank **112**.

(55) The seal cartridge **136** can include at least one body extending axially from at least one of the first arm **140** or the second arm **142**. As a non-limiting example, the first arm **140** can include a first retention body **146** that extends axially forward from the first arm **140**, and the second arm **142** can include a second retention body **148** that extends axially rearward from the second arm **142**. When the blade **104** is provided within the blade seat **144**, the first retention body **146** and the second retention body **148** each extend beyond a respective portion of the blade **104**, specifically the shank **112**, in the axial direction. The first retention body **146** and the second retention body **148** are used to retain the seal cartridge **136** to the blade **104**. The first retention body **146** and the second retention body **148** can take any suitable form. As a non-limiting example, the first retention body **146** and the second retention body **148** can each be formed as angel wings.

(56) The seal cartridge **136** can be coupled to the blade **104** by inserting the blade **104** into the blade seat **144**. The blade **104** and the seal cartridge **136** are both coupled to the rotatable disk **102** by inserting the shank **112** and the seal cartridge **136** into a respective slot of the plurality of slots **108**. It is contemplated that the seal cartridge **136** can be sized to fit within a respective slot of the plurality of slots **108**. As a non-limiting example, the lower parts of the first arm **140** and the second arm **142** can match the cross section of the respective slot, such that the seal cartridge **136** sits flush against the respective slot. Alternatively, a gap can be found between the respective slot and the seal cartridge **136**. As a non-limiting example, the seal cartridge **136** slides into the forward opening of the slot, **138** first, and axial position in the slot is set by where the first arm **140** contacts the forward surface **130** of the rotatable disk **102**. The airfoil portion **110** extends radially outward from the peripheral surface **134** through the peripheral opening **105**. The seal cartridge **136** and the blade **104** are held in place by frictional contact with the slot **108** or can be coupled to the slot **108** via any suitable coupling method such as, but not limited to, welding, adhesion, fastening, or the like. The axial retainer assembly **178**, specifically the axial retainer **190**, keeps the seal cartridge **136**, and therefore the blade **104**, within the slot **108**.

(57) While only a single blade **104** and a single seal cartridge **136** are illustrated, it will be appreciated that there can be any number of one or more blades **104** and accompanying seal cartridges **136** in the blade assembly **100**. As a non-limiting example, the total number of blades

104 and seal cartridges **136** can correspond to the total number of slots in the plurality of slots **108**. (58) While described as the blade **104** being mounted to a rotatable disk **102**, it will be appreciated that the blade **104** can be any suitable static or rotating airfoil. In terms of the former, the blade **104** can be mounted to a static body, as opposed to the rotatable disk. As such, the blade **104** can be at least one of the static compressor vanes **60**, **62** (FIG. 1), the set of compressor blades **56**, **58** (FIG. 1), the static turbine vanes **72**, **74** (FIG. 1), the set of turbine blades **68**, **70** (FIG. 1), or the plurality of fan blades **42**. In the instance where the blade **104** is mounted to a stationary component of the turbine engine **10**, the body identified by the rotatable disk **102** can be any suitable stationary portion of the turbine engine **10** that the blade **104** is couplable to, such as, but not limited to, a band, a shroud, a casing, or the like.

(59) The blade assembly **100** can be made of any suitable material. As a non-limiting example, the blade **104** can include a composite material such that the blade **104** can be defined as a composite blade. As a non-limiting example, the rotatable disk **102** can include a metallic material such that the rotatable disk **102** can be defined as a metallic disk. As a non-limiting example, the seal cartridge **136** can include a metallic material such that the seal cartridge **136** can be defined as a metallic seal cartridge.

(60) FIG. 3 is a schematic top perspective view of the seal cartridge **136** of FIG. 2. The plate **138** includes a plate lower surface **150** and a plate upper surface **152**. A pocket **154** can be formed along the plate upper surface **152**.

(61) At least one of the first arm **140** or the second arm **142** can include a stop **156**. As a non-limiting example, the first arm **140** can include a stop **156**. The stop **156** can press against the blade **104** (FIG. 2), when the blade is received within the blade seat **144**, and hold the seal cartridge **136** in frictional contact with the blade **104**. The stop **156** can define a portion of the seal cartridge **136** that comes into direct contact with the blade **104** when the blade **104** is received within the blade seat **144**. The stop **156** can extend circumferentially between a first end **157** and a second end **159**. The first end **157** and the second end **159** can be circumferentially spaced from or sit flush with circumferential ends of the first arm **140**.

(62) At least one of the first arm **140** or the second arm **142** can include a protrusion **160** extending from the first arm **140** or the second arm **142**. As a non-limiting example, the second arm **142** includes the protrusion **160**. The protrusion **160** is defined by a region of the second arm **142** that extends circumferentially away from the second arm **142**. The protrusion **160** includes a triangular cross-sectional area when viewed along a plane perpendicular to the rotational axis **106** (FIG. 2) and intersecting the protrusion **160**. For purposes of illustration, a division **162** between the protrusion **160** and a remainder of the second arm **142** is illustrated. While illustrated as including a triangular cross-sectional area, it will be appreciated that the cross-sectional area can be any suitable shape configured to create the protrusion **160** along the seal cartridge **136**. Alternatively, the protrusion **160** can be excluded from the seal cartridge **136** in some assemblies. As a non-limiting example, the protrusion **160** can be excluded when the rotatable disk **102** does not include a skewed slot.

(63) The protrusion **160** can include a radially inner surface **182** that confronts the peripheral surface **134** (FIG. 2) of the rotatable disk **102** (FIG. 2). For purposes of illustration, a perimeter **184** of the rotatable disk **102** defined by the peripheral surface **134** has been illustrated. The radially inner surface **182** can be spaced from or contact the peripheral surface **134**. The radially inner surface **182** can be formed such that it follows the contour of the perimeter **184** defined by the peripheral surface **134**.

(64) The seal cartridge **136** includes a seal channel **164** extending circumferentially through at least one arm of the seal cartridge **136**. As a non-limiting example, the seal channel **164** extend circumferentially through the second arm **142**. As a non-limiting example, the seal channel **164** can extend through the protrusion **160**.

(65) FIG. 4 is a schematic bottom perspective view of the seal cartridge **136** of FIG. 2. The seal

cartridge **136** can include a third arm **128** that extends radially inward from the plate **138**.

(66) When assembled with the rotatable disk (FIG. 2), the third arm **136** can define an axial stop of the seal cartridge **136**. The third arm **128** can be a continuation of one of the first arm **140** or the second arm. At least one flow passage **166** can be provided within the third arm **128**. The seal cartridge **136** can further include a flow meter **168** defining an additional arm that extends radially inwardly from the plate **138**. The flow meter **168** can be provided aft of or downstream of the at least one flow passage **166**. Alternatively, the at least one flow passage **166** can act as flow meter such that the flow meter **168** is not required. During operation, a flow of fluid can flow between the seal cartridge **136**, specifically the lower surface **150**, and the rotatable disk **102** (FIG. 2). The flow meter **168** can be used to control a rate at which the fluid flows between the seal cartridge **136** and the rotatable disk **102**. The flow meter **168** can further act as a leg extending from the plate **138** that defines a radial stop. In other words, the flow meter **168** can contact a portion of the disk **102** and space the plate **138** from the disk **102**.

(67) FIG. 5 is a schematic side cross-sectional view of the blade assembly **100** of FIG. 2 viewed from the circumferential direction. The shank **112** is received at least partially in the blade seat **144**. The seal cartridge **136** and the shank **112** are received within a respective slot of the plurality of slots **108**. At least a portion of the shank **112** can extend into the pocket **154**. Alternatively, the pocket **154** can define a region where the shank **112** does not extend into.

(68) The rotatable disk **102** and the seal cartridge **136** can be coupled to one another through any suitable method. As a non-limiting example, an axial retainer assembly **178** can be coupled to or integrally formed with a respective portion of the rotatable disk **102**. The axial retainer assembly **178** includes a retainer slot **179** that an axial retainer received within the retainer slot **179**. The axial retainer **190** can apply a force against the retainer slot **179** and a respective portion of the seal cartridge **136** (e.g., the first arm **140** and the third arm **128**) and retain the seal cartridge **136** in the illustrated position. The axial retainer assembly **178** can prevent the seal cartridge **136** from moving axially within the slot **108**.

(69) The axial retainer **190** can be any suitable device configured to retain the seal cartridge **136** to the rotatable disk **102**. As a non-limiting example, the axial retainer **190** can be a retainer ring. The axial retainer **190** can contact any suitable portion of the seal cartridge **136**. As a non-limiting example, the axial retainer **190** can contact the first arm **140**. The axial retainer **190** can be provided along a side of the rotatable disk **102** corresponding to at least one of the forward surface **130** or the aft surface **132**. As a non-limiting example, the blade assembly **100** can include two axial retainers: one provided along a portion of the rotatable disk **102** corresponding to the forward surface **130** and another provided along a portion of the rotatable disk **102** corresponding to the aft surface **132**. Alternatively, the rotatable disk **102** and the seal cartridge **136** can be coupled to each other through any suitable method such as, but not limited to, welding, adhesion, fastening, or a combination thereof.

(70) The axial retainer **190** can be a split ring retainer such that each seal cartridge **136** or each set of seal cartridges **136** includes a respective axial retainer **190**. As such, the axial retainer **190** can be included within a plurality of axial retainers segmented circumferentially about the rotational axis **106**. Alternatively, the axial retainer **190** can be a continuous retainer that retains each seal cartridge **136** of the blade assembly **100** to a respective portion of the rotatable disk **102**.

(71) The first arm **140** extends radially along the leading edge **114** of the blade **104**. The second arm **142** extends radially along the trailing edge **116** of the blade **104**. The plate **138** extends axially along the root **118**. The first arm **140** and the second arm **142** can terminate radially inward of, in conjunction with, or radially outward of the transition **126** between the airfoil portion **110** and the shank **112**.

(72) A first gap **186** is formed between the seal cartridge **136** and the rotatable disk **102**. The first gap **186** is formed by the axial space between the third arm **128** and the forward surface **130** (e.g., the space formed by the cooling passage **166**), and between the lower surface **150** and the radially

inner surface **180**. The flow meter **168** can extend through the first gap **186**. A second gap **188** is formed between the seal cartridge **136** and the shank **112**. The second gap **188** is formed between an axial space between the first arm **140** and the shank **112**, and between the upper surface **152** and the root **118**. The second gap **188** can be at least partially formed by the pocket **154**.

(73) The first gap **186** and the second gap **188** can be any suitable size. As a non-limiting example, the first gap **186** and the second gap **188** can each be large enough to allow a fluid (e.g., air) to pass therethrough. The first gap **186** and the second gap **188** can further be size by any suitable portion of the blade assembly **100**. As a non-limiting example, the flow meter **168**, specifically the radial extent of the flow meter **168**, can be sized to determine the size of the first gap **186**. As a non-limiting example, the size of the pocket **154** can define the size of the second gap **188**.

(74) During operation of the turbine engine (e.g., the turbine engine **10** of FIG. **1**) that the blade assembly **100** is provided within, a working airflow (Fw) can flow over the blade **104**, such as over the airfoil portion **110**. Due to the shaping of the airfoil portion **110**, the blade **104** can extract work from the working airflow (Fw) and be used to either drive the rotatable disk **102**; or be driven by the rotatable disk **102** and compress the working airflow (Fw) as it flows from the leading edge **114** to the trailing edge **116**.

(75) It is contemplated that the blade assembly **100** can be provided downstream of an upstream assembly **196**. The upstream assembly **196** can be any suitable assembly such as, but not limited to, a blade assembly including a blade or a vane. A secondary airflow path **198** can be formed between the upstream assembly **196** and the blade assembly **100**. During operation, a leakage airflow (Fle) can flow through the secondary airflow path **198** and merge with the working airflow (Fw). The movement of the leakage airflow (Fle) from the secondary airflow path **198** can push the working airflow (Fw) away from the rotatable disk **102** and prevent the working airflow (Fw) from flowing down towards the seal cartridge **136**. Alternatively, at least a portion of the working airflow (Fw) can flow towards the seal cartridge **136** as illustrated in phantom lines.

(76) It is contemplated that the leakage airflow (Fle) can further be defined by its temperature with respect to the working airflow (Fw). Specifically, the leakage airflow (Fle) has a lower temperature than a temperature of the working airflow (Fw).

(77) It is contemplated that the working airflow (Fw) can be defined by the hot combustion gases created as a byproduct of combustion. As such, the working airflow (Fw) will heat portions of the blade assembly **100** that the working airflow (Fw) comes into contact with. As discussed herein, the blade **104** can include a composite material and the rotatable disk **102** can include a metallic material. Some composite materials can heat up significantly faster and retain heat for significantly longer than metallic materials. With such composite materials, the blade **104** will be hotter than and stay hotter than the rotatable disk **102**. Composite materials, however, have been found to have the highest strength when uniformly heated as opposed to having some areas significantly hotter or colder than other areas. In other words, composite materials perform best when there is a low thermal gradient experienced along the composite material. However, as certain portions of the rotatable disk **102** that do not come into direct contact with the working airflow (Fw) are colder than the blade **104**. As a non-limiting example, contact between the shank **112**, and the slot inner surface **180** can cool down the shank **112**. The cooling down of the shank **112**, in turn, results in a thermal gradient being experienced along the blade **104**.

(78) The seal cartridge **136**, however, provides thermal insulation between the disk (e.g., the slot inner surface **180**) and the root **118** of the shank **112**. The thermal insulation provided by the seal cartridge **136** reduces or eliminates a thermal gradient across the blade **104**. Accordingly, potential damage to the blade **104** and the rotatable disk **102** can be reduced or eliminated.

(79) The first gap **186** (the spacing between the seal cartridge **136** and the rotatable disk **102**) defines a first thermal passage. The second gap **188** (the spacing between the seal cartridge **136** and the shank **112**) forms a second thermal passage. The first thermal passage and the second thermal passage insulate the blade **104**, the rotatable disk **102** and the seal cartridge **136** from one another.

The seal cartridge **136** is configured to direct fluid through the thermal passages to define layers of insulation between the seal cartridge **136** and the rotatable disk **102**, and between the seal cartridge **136** and the blade **104**.

(80) As a non-limiting example, the seal cartridge **136** is configured to direct a first flow of insulating fluid (Fi1) through the first thermal passage and a second flow of insulating fluid (Fi2) through the second thermal passage. The first thermal passage directs the first flow of insulating fluid (Fi1) between the seal cartridge **136** and the rotatable disk **102**. The second thermal passage directs the second flow of insulating fluid (Fi2) between the seal cartridge **136** and the blade **104**. The second insulating fluid (Fi2) can flow around the stop **156** (e.g., around the first end **157**, the second end **159**, or a combination thereof), through a gap between the stop **156** and the shank **112**, through channels (not illustrated) formed within the stop **156**, around the first arm **140**, or a combination thereof. The first flow of insulating fluid (Fi1) and the second flow of insulating fluid (Fi2) limit a transfer of heat between the rotatable disk **102** and the seal cartridge **136**, and between the blade **104** and the seal cartridge **136**, respectively.

(81) The first thermal passage can be fluidly coupled to a bleed air (Fb). The bleed air (Fb) can be any suitable air that has a lower temperature than the working airflow (Fw). The bleed air (Fb), for example, can be an air that is drawn from an upstream section of the turbine engine **10**. Alternatively, the bleed air (Fb) can be drawn from the leakage air (Fle). It will be appreciated that the bleed air (Fb) can include the leakage air (Fle), a bleed air form upstream of the blade assembly **100**, or a combination thereof.

(82) It is further contemplated that the seal cartridge **136** can be hotter than the rotatable disk **102**, and the first flow of insulating fluid (Fi1) can then be used to cool the plate lower surface **150** of the seal cartridge **136** to limit any heat transfer between the rotatable disk **102** and the plate lower surface **150** of the seal cartridge **136**. The flow meter **168** can be provided within the first thermal passage to effectively meter, retard, or otherwise prevent uncontrolled egress of the first flow of insulating fluid (Fi1) from the first thermal passage.

(83) At least one of the working airflow (Fw) or the leakage airflow (Fle) is directed by the second thermal passage to provide the second flow of insulating fluid (Fi2). Whatever airflow is funneled into the second thermal passage defines the second flow of insulating fluid (Fi2). The second insulating fluid flow (Fi2) can flow between the first arm **140** and the shank **112** and into the second thermal passage. The second insulating fluid flow (Fi2) within the second thermal passage can form a layer of insulation between the plate upper surface **152** of the seal cartridge **136** and the root **118**, thus reducing or eliminating heat transfer between the seal cartridge **136** and the blade **104**. The second insulating fluid flow (Fi2) within the second thermal passage can further heat the root **118**, surrounding portions of the rotatable disk **102** and the plate upper surface **152** of the seal cartridge **136** to help these regions be at a similar temperature, thus reducing the heat transfer at the root **118** and overall decreasing the thermal gradient across the blade **104**.

(84) For purposes of illustration, the fluid entering the second thermal passage has been shown to come from both the leakage airflow (Fle) and the working airflow (Fw) as phantom lines. The second thermal passage can be coupled to either the leakage airflow (Fle), the working airflow (Fw), or a combination thereof depending on the location of the blade assembly **100**. As a non-limiting example, if the blade assembly **100** is provided within the compressor section **22**, the second thermal passage can be fluidly coupled to the working airflow (Fw), the leakage airflow (Fle), or a combination thereof. As a non-limiting example, if the blade assembly is provided within the turbine section **32** (FIG. 1), the second thermal passage can be fluidly coupled to the leakage airflow (Fle). The determination of what the second thermal passage is fluidly coupled to may be based on the temperature of the working airflow (Fw). As a non-limiting example, the working airflow (Fw) in the turbine section **32** is hotter than the working airflow (Fw) in the compressor section **22**. The temperature of the working airflow (Fw) in the turbine section **32** may be too hot to supply to the second thermal passage while the temperature of the working airflow

(Fw) in the compressor section **24** may be low enough to supply to the second thermal passage. (85) While described in terms of a thermal gradient experienced across the blade **104** due to the blade **104** being hotter than the rotatable disk **102**, it will be appreciated that the situation can be reversed. As non-limiting example, it is contemplated that the rotatable disk **102** can be hotter than the blade **104**. In either case (e.g., the blade **104** is hotter or colder than the rotatable disk **102**), the seal cartridge **136** is used to form a thermal insulation between the blade **104** and the rotatable disk **102**.

(86) During operation, the blade **104** can rotate about the rotational axis **106**. This rotation, in turn, transfers a centrifugal force (Fcf) to the seal cartridge **136**. The centrifugal forces (Fcf) create a moment on the first retention body **146** and the second retention body **148**. This moment, in turn, creates a first retention force (Fr1) and a second retention force (Fr2). The first retention force (Fr1) forces the first arm **140** against the shank **112** in the direction indicated by the arrow of the first retention force (Fr1). The second retention force (Fr2) forces the second arm against the shank **112** in the direction indicated by the arrow of the second retention force (Fr2). the first arm **140** and the second arm **142** towards the shank **112**, thus securing the seal cartridge **136** to the shank **112**. It is contemplated that the larger an axial extent of the first retention body **146** and the second retention body **148**, the larger the moment and thus the tighter the first arm **140** and the second arm **142** are pressed against the shank **112**. While described in terms of the first retaining force (Fr1) and the second retaining force (Fr2) being used to secure the seal cartridge **136** to the blade **104**, it will be appreciated that the seal cartridge **136** can be secured to the blade **104** through any suitable method such as, but not limited to, adhesion, fastening, clamping, welding, bonding, or a combination thereof. Further, it will be appreciated that only a single arm of the seal cartridge **136** can be sufficient to secure to secure the seal cartridge **136** to the blade **104**.

(87) It is contemplated that the heating of the blade **104**, the seal cartridge **136**, and the rotatable disk **102** can cause thermal expansion of the blade **104**, the seal cartridge **136**, or the rotatable disk **102**. As the seal cartridge **136** is coupled to the rotatable disk **102** and is formed such that at least the first retaining force (Fr1) or the second retaining force (Fr2) is generated during rotation of the blade assembly **100**, the blade **104** will not become dislodged from either of the rotatable disk **102** or the seal cartridge **136**.

(88) FIG. 6 is a forward-facing schematic view of an aft end of the blade assembly **100** of FIG. 2 with the blade **104** (FIG. 2) removed. As illustrated, the blade assembly **100** includes two circumferentially adjacent seal cartridges **136**. The seal cartridges **136** can collectively form a segmented body that extends circumferentially about the rotational axis **106**. The seal cartridges **136** can be segmented about an entirety of the rotational axis **106**.

(89) The circumferentially adjacent seal cartridges **136** are spaced from one another to define a circumferential gap **170** therebetween. A seal **172** can be provided to seal an airflow (e.g., the working airflow (Fw) or the leakage airflow (Fle) of FIG. 5) from flowing through the circumferential gap **170**. The prevention of the airflow from flowing through the circumferential gap **170** can in turn force a larger volume of the working airflow flows over the blade **104** (FIG. 2). The larger the volume of air flowing over the blade **104**, the more work that the blade **104** extracts from the working airflow (Fw). The seal **172** can extend circumferentially through the seal channel **164** (FIG. 3) of each seal cartridge **136**. The seal **172** can extend continuously or non-continuously circumferentially about the rotational axis **106**. The seal **172** can be any suitable seal such as, but not limited to, a spline seal. While shown as extending circumferentially from and through the second arm **142**, it will be appreciated that the seal **172** can be provided along any suitable portion of the seal cartridge **136** such as, but not limited to, the first arm **140**, the second arm **142** or a combination thereof. While illustrated as a circumferential gap **170** having a constant circumferential distance between opposing portions of the seal cartridges **136**, it will be appreciated that the circumferential gap **170** can be non-constant.

(90) The protrusion **160** can further be used to limit or otherwise prevent the flow of fluid between

the seal cartridges **136**. As a non-limiting example, each seal cartridge **136** can include a body (e.g., the protrusion **160**) that extends circumferentially along the rotatable disk **102**, thus creating a barrier to the flow of fluid between adjacent seal cartridges **136**.

(91) During operation of the turbine engine (e.g., the turbine engine **10** of FIG. **1**) that the blade assembly **100** is provided within, the rotation of the blade assembly **100** can cause the seal cartridge **136** to experience a circumferential force (F_{ci}) in a direction opposite the direction of rotation. The circumferential force (F_{ci}) can be caused, for example, by a drag of the blade assembly **100**. The circumferential force (F_{ci}) can create a moment on the seal cartridge **136**, which can cause the seal cartridge **136** to turn in the slot **108** in the direction indicated by the arrow of the circumferential force (F_{ci}). To counteract the circumferential force (F_{ci}), each seal cartridge **136** includes a respective protrusion **160**. The protrusion **160** is sized and positioned to limit the effects of the circumferential force (F_{ci}). This, in turn, reduces or eliminates the potential for the seal cartridge **136** to be damaged by the circumferential force (F_{ci}).

(92) Benefits of the presented disclosure include a blade with a reduced or eliminated thermal gradient when compared to a traditional blade. For example, traditional blades, specifically traditional blades including a composite material, will experience a large thermal gradient due to the difference of temperature between the traditional blade and the rotatable disk that the traditional blade is received within. The blade assembly as described herein, however, includes the seal cartridge that forms an insulative barrier through the seal cartridge itself and through the first thermal passage and the second thermal passage between the blade and the rotatable disk. These layers of insulation ultimately created by the seal cartridge help to reduce or eliminate the thermal gradient experienced across the blade is minimal and does not damage the blade when compared to the traditional blade. Further, the flows of insulating fluid can be used to heat or cool respective portions of the blade assembly. As a non-limiting example, the first flow of insulation fluid can be used to cool the rotatable disk **102**, thus minimizing the thermal gradient along the disk. As a non-limiting example, the second flow of insulating fluid can be used to heat the blade, thus minimizing the thermal gradient along the blade.

(93) Additional benefits of the presented disclosure include a seal cartridge that couple the blade to the rotatable disk. For example, traditional assemblies can include a seal provided between the blade and the rotatable disk, and separate elements that effectively couples the blade to the rotatable disk. The blade assembly as described herein, however, includes the seal cartridge defined by a unitary body including both a seal (e.g., the plate, the first arm and the second arm) and a retaining feature (e.g., the first arm, the second arm and the third arm), such that the seal cartridge effectively provides a layer of insulation between the blade and the rotatable disk while also retaining the blade to the rotatable disk without the need for additional separate clamping elements.

(94) Additional benefits associated with the use of a composite blade include a lighter assembly without sacrificing performance of the blade assembly when compared to a traditional assembly including a non-composite (e.g., cast) blade. In other words, the material used for the composite blade is lighter than the materials used for the non-composite blade and do not sacrifice the ability to perform as intended within the turbine engine. The decreased weight of the blade, and thus the blade assembly as a whole, in turn, means an increased efficiency of the turbine engine when compared to a conventional turbine engine including the non-composite blade.

(95) To the extent not already described, the different features and structures of the various embodiments can be used in combination, or in substitution with each other as desired. That one feature is not illustrated in all of the embodiments is not meant to be construed that it cannot be so illustrated, but is done for brevity of description. Thus, the various features of the different embodiments can be mixed and matched as desired to form new embodiments, whether or not the new embodiments are expressly described. All combinations or permutations of features described herein are covered by this disclosure.

(96) This written description uses examples to describe aspects of the disclosure described herein,

including the best mode, and also to enable any person skilled in the art to practice aspects of the disclosure, including making and using any devices or systems and performing any incorporated methods. The patentable scope of aspects of the disclosure is defined by the claims, and may include other examples that occur to those skilled in the art. Such other examples are intended to be within the scope of the claims if they have structural elements that do not differ from the literal language of the claims, or if they include equivalent structural elements with insubstantial differences from the literal languages of the claims.

(97) Further aspects are provided by the subject matter of the following clauses:

(98) A blade assembly for a turbine engine, the blade assembly comprising a rotatable disk including a peripheral surface, a slot formed along the peripheral surface, and a rotational axis, a seal cartridge including a plate at least partially received within the slot, and a first arm extending radially from the plate, the plate being spaced from the rotatable disk to define a first gap therebetween, and a blade including a root, a leading edge, and a trailing edge, the root being spaced from the plate to define a second gap therebetween, wherein the root is received within the slot, the plate is between the root and the rotatable disk, the first arm extends radially and is located at one of the leading edge or the trailing edge of the blade, a first thermal passage is at least partially defined by the first gap, and a second thermal passage is at least partially defined by the second gap.

(99) An blade assembly for a turbine engine, the blade assembly comprising a rotatable disk having a peripheral surface, with at least one slot located in the peripheral surface, a seal cartridge having a plate at least partially received within the slot, the seal cartridge having a first arm extending radially from the plate, the plate and the first arm defining a blade seat, and a blade having a root, a leading edge and a trailing edge, the root being received within the blade seat, with the first arm extending radially along at least a portion of one of the leading edge or the trailing edge, the first arm and the seal cartridge forming a unitary body.

(100) An blade assembly for a turbine engine, the turbine engine having a working airflow pathway, the blade assembly comprising a working airflow pathway, a rotatable disk having a peripheral surface, with at least one slot located in the peripheral surface, a seal cartridge having a plate at least partially received within the slot and defining a blade seat, the plate being spaced from the rotatable disk to define a first gap therebetween, and a blade at least partially provided within the working airflow path, the blade having a root, a leading edge and a trailing edge, the root being received within the blade seat, the root being spaced from the plate to define a second gap therebetween wherein a first thermal passage at least partially defined by the first gap, the first thermal passage being fluidly coupled to a leakage airflow from the working airflow path, a second thermal passage at least partially defined by the second gap, the second thermal passage being fluidly coupled to a bleed air from a portion of the turbine engine upstream of the blade.

(101) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the first arm and the seal cartridge form a unitary body.

(102) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the blade comprises a shank terminating at the root, and the plate comprises a pocket that receives the shank.

(103) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the first arm includes a retention body extending axially away from the blade.

(104) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the retention body is an angel wing.

(105) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the first arm provides a retention force against the blade.

(106) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the seal cartridge includes a second arm, the second arm is axially-spaced rearwardly from the first arm, the second arm extends radially from the plate, and the blade is received on the plate and between the first arm and the second arm.

(107) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the first arm and the second arm each

include a respective retention body extending axially away from the blade.

(108) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the rotatable disk includes a forward surface, and the seal cartridge includes a second arm extending radially inwardly from the plate along the forward surface.

(109) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the seal cartridge includes at least one flow passage formed within the second arm, the at least one flow passage defining a respective portion of the second gap.

(110) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the seal cartridge includes a flow meter provided downstream of the at least one flow passage and extending radially inward from the plate, through the gap and contacting the rotatable disk.

(111) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, further comprising an axial retainer assembly including a retainer slot and an axial retainer provided within the retainer slot, the axial retainer confronting a respective portion of the seal cartridge to retain the seal cartridge to the rotatable disk.

(112) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the axial retainer assembly is integrally formed with the rotatable disk.

(113) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the seal cartridge comprises the first arm extending along a forward portion of the plate, a second arm extending radially outward from an aft portion of the plate, axially opposite the forward portion, and a third arm extending radially inward from the forward portion, with the first arm, the second arm and the third arm formed as a unitary body.

(114) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the rotatable disk includes a plurality of circumferentially spaced slots, the blade is provided within a plurality of circumferentially spaced blades, with each blade of the plurality of circumferentially spaced blades including a respective root provided within a respective slot of the plurality of circumferentially spaced slots, and the seal cartridge is included within a plurality of circumferentially spaced seal cartridges, with each circumferentially adjacent seal cartridge of the plurality of circumferentially spaced seal cartridges being circumferentially spaced from each other to define a seal gap therebetween.

(115) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, further comprising a spline seal extending circumferentially through and outward from the first arm.

(116) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the spline seal extends circumferentially about an entirety of the rotational axis.

(117) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the first arm includes a protrusion extending from the first arm, the protrusion having a radially inner surface that follows a contour of the peripheral surface, the protrusion configured to contact the peripheral surface during operation of the blade assembly.

(118) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the blade includes a composite material, and the rotatable disk includes a metallic material.

(119) The blade assembly of any preceding clause, wherein the turbine engine further comprises a turbine section, with the blade and the rotatable disk being provided with the turbine section.

Claims

1. A blade assembly for a turbine engine, the blade assembly comprising: a rotatable disk including a peripheral surface, a slot formed along the peripheral surface, and a rotational axis; a seal cartridge including a plate at least partially received within the slot, and an arm extending radially from the plate, the plate being spaced from the rotatable disk to define a first gap therebetween; and a blade including a root, a leading edge, and a trailing edge, the root being spaced from the plate and a respective portion of the arm to define a second gap therebetween; wherein: the root is received within the slot, the plate is between the root and the rotatable disk, the arm extends

radially along at least a portion of the blade; a first thermal passage is at least partially defined by the first gap, the first thermal passage forming a first fluid passage having a first fluid inlet formed between the seal cartridge and the rotatable disk, the first thermal passage configured to direct a first flow of insulating fluid through the first gap; and a second thermal passage is at least partially defined by the second gap, the second thermal passage forming a second fluid passage having a second fluid inlet formed between the seal cartridge and a respective portion of the blade, the second thermal passage being configured to direct a second flow of insulating fluid through the second gap.

2. The blade assembly of claim 1, wherein the blade comprises a shank terminating at the root, and the plate comprises a pocket that receives the shank.
3. The blade assembly of claim 1, wherein the arm includes a retention body extending axially away from the blade.
4. The blade assembly of claim 3, wherein the retention body is an angel wing.
5. The blade assembly of claim 1, wherein the arm provides a retention force against the blade.
6. The blade assembly of claim 1, wherein: the arm is a first arm extending radially along at least a portion of the leading edge; the seal cartridge includes a second arm axially-spaced rearwardly from the first arm and extending radially along at least a portion of the trailing edge; the second arm extends radially from the plate; and the blade is received on the plate and between the first arm and the second arm.
7. The blade assembly of claim 6, wherein the first arm and the second arm each include a respective retention body extending axially away from the blade.
8. The blade assembly of claim 1, wherein the rotatable disk includes a forward surface, and the seal cartridge includes a second arm extending radially inwardly from the plate along the forward surface.
9. The blade assembly of claim 8, wherein the seal cartridge includes at least one flow passage formed within the second arm, the at least one flow passage defining a respective portion of the second gap.
10. The blade assembly of claim 9, wherein the seal cartridge includes a flow meter provided downstream of the at least one flow passage and extending radially inward from the plate, through the first gap and contacting the rotatable disk.
11. The blade assembly of claim 1, further comprising an axial retainer assembly including a retainer slot and an axial retainer provided within the retainer slot, the axial retainer confronting a respective portion of the seal cartridge to retain the seal cartridge to the rotatable disk.
12. The blade assembly of claim 11, wherein the retainer slot is integrally formed with the rotatable disk.
13. The blade assembly of claim 1, wherein the arm is a first arm extending radially along at least a portion of the leading edge, and the seal cartridge comprises: the first arm extending along a forward portion of the plate; a second arm extending radially along at least a portion of the trailing edge and radially outward from an aft portion of the plate, axially opposite the forward portion; and a third arm extending radially inward from the forward portion, with the first arm, the second arm and the third arm formed as a unitary body.
14. The blade assembly of claim 1, wherein: the slot is included in a plurality of circumferentially spaced slots; the blade is provided within a plurality of circumferentially spaced blades, with each blade of the plurality of circumferentially spaced blades including a respective root provided within a respective slot of the plurality of circumferentially spaced slots; and the seal cartridge is included within a plurality of circumferentially spaced seal cartridges, with each circumferentially adjacent seal cartridge of the plurality of circumferentially spaced seal cartridges being circumferentially spaced from each other to define a seal gap therebetween.
15. The blade assembly of claim 1, further comprising a spline seal extending circumferentially through and outward from the arm.

16. The blade assembly of claim 15, wherein the spline seal extends circumferentially about an entirety of a circumference of the rotational axis.

17. The blade assembly of claim 1, wherein the first arm includes a protrusion extending from the arm, the protrusion having a radially inner surface that follows a contour of the peripheral surface, the protrusion configured to contact the peripheral surface during operation of the blade assembly.

18. The blade assembly of claim 1, wherein the blade includes a composite material, and the rotatable disk includes a metallic material.

19. The blade assembly of claim 1, wherein the turbine engine comprises a working airflow that flows over a respective portion of the blade, with the second flow of insulating fluid being at least partially defined by the working airflow.

20. The blade assembly of claim 1, wherein the second flow of insulating fluid is configured to heat a respective portion of the blade.
